

Rabbis Review

17

RABBIT V. GRANDMASTER!

By Ian Josephs
Ramsgate International Sponsor

In the October/November issue of "Chess" I came across a miniature that shows how a Grandmaster such as Tony Miles can usually wipe the floor with a top class International Master - I refer of course to our genial Editor Mike Basman and his 4th round "effort" in the Benedictine.

I give the "score" to show just how it was done.

Basman v. Miles

1P-KN4 P-K4 2P-KR3 P-Q4 3B-N2 N-QB3 4P-QB4 PxP 5Q-R4 KN-K2
6N-KB3 NN3 7N-B3?! B-K3 8P-R4?! B-QN5 9N-KN5 B-Q2 10B-Q5 0-0
11Q-B2 BxP 12Q-K4 B-Q2 13NxRP N-Q5! 14P-R5 NB5 15NxR QxN 16K-B1
R-K1 17BxQBP B-B3 18N-Q5 Q-B4 19P.Q3 NxN 20R-KN1 NB5 21Q-K3
Q-B1 22Q-N3 N(Q5)xKP and white (Basman) - battered, bleeding and ruined
lost on time.

This game stirred me to challenge Tony Miles to see if I could do any better than an I.M. and as Tony was staying in my hotel for the Regency Masters in Ramsgate, I asked him to wipe me off the board as quick as you can say 'Mike Basman' and we played the following game in which I tried to follow the rules I gave you in the previous issues.

Miles, fresh from beating Karpov (and Basman) seemed relaxed and confident!

WHITE

Ian Josephs

1P-K4
(I'll pretend he didn't do that!)

2N-KB3

3P-Q4

4N-B3

5B-QB4

BLACK

Tony Miles

N-QB3

P-Q3

N-B3

B-N5

P-K3

Pity! I wanted to play BxBP ch!
(Good thing he didn't let you - it
loses a piece - Ed)

6P-QR3

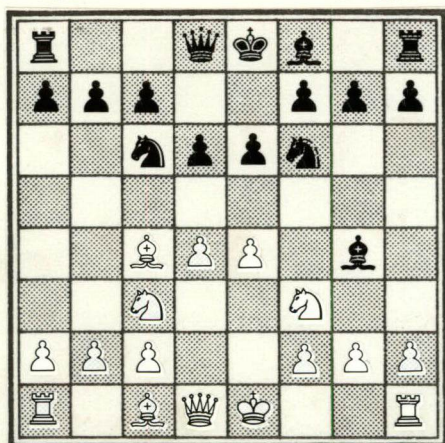
What a stupid waste of time, and breaking
my own rules as well!

6 ...

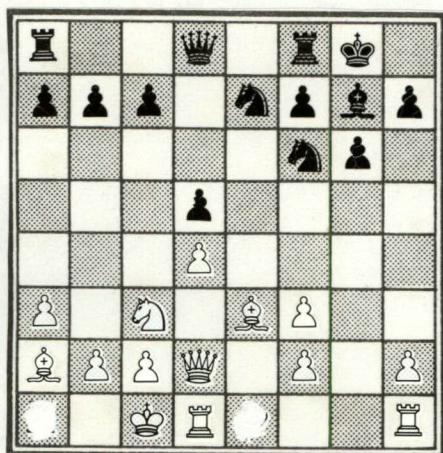
BxN

7PxB

White must now recapture with pawn,
allowing doubled pawns near the king,
because 7QxB would have been answered
by ...NxQP winning a pawn.



7...	P-Q4
8PxP	PxP
9B-R2	P-KN3
10B-K3	P-KN3
11Q-Q2	B-N2
120-0-0	0-0



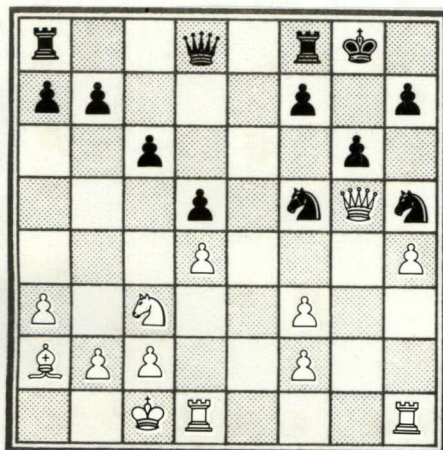
I seem to have developed OK anyway.

13B-R6	BxB
14QxB	N-B4
15Q-N5	P-B3
16P-KR4	

(Attack!)

16...	N-R4
-------	------

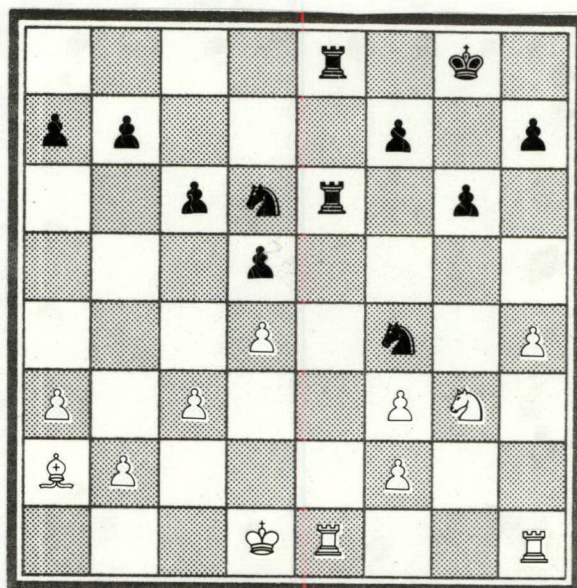
(End of Attack)



17N-K2	R-K1
18QR-K1	R-K3
19QxQ ch	

(I only did this because I thought Miles knew more tricks with his queen than I did!)

19...	RxQ
20P-B3	R(Q1)-K1
21K-Q1	N-Q3
22N-N3	N-KB5



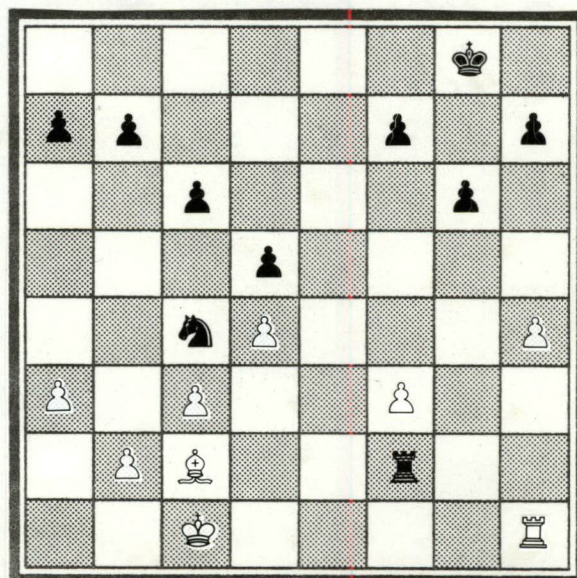
At this point I do feel at least that I am doing better than BASMAN - who lost after 22 moves in a hopeless position! In my game I admit black's pieces are more active than mine, and my white squared bishop, in theory 'good' because most of my pawns are on black squares, is in fact bad because all his pawns seem to be hemming me in. However, its certainly not a lost position in spite of my doubled pawns, bad bishop and shaky defence of the only open file, as long as I don't give his knight too many squares he'll have a job to break through.

So what did I do then? I allowed ...N-QB5 and an attack - IDIOT!

23RxR	RxR
-------	-----

Here I intended to follow up with 24R-K1, but saw 24...RxRch 25KxR N-Q6 ch So...

24B-N1	N-B5
25K-B1	N-K7 ch
26NxN	RxN
27B-B2	RxP

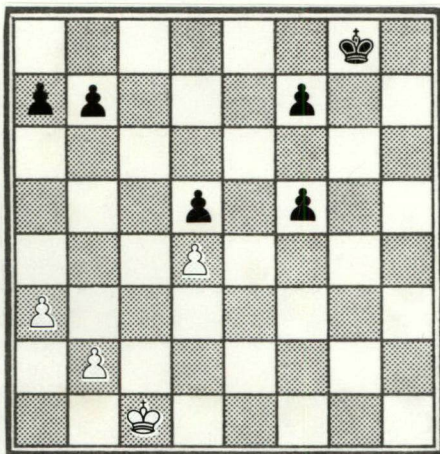


Well, it took him 27 moves to win a pawn!
28P-R5

Why didn't I protect my pawn at B3?
Because I overlooked it! I forgot to
check all the pins, forks and captures
that time.

28... N-K6

29B-N1 RxBP (Two pawns up - that's
serious!) 30PXP RPXP 31R-K1 R-B8
32RxR NxR 33B-Q3 N-N6 34P-B4
N-B4 (I thought I might be able to stop
his passed pawns if they doubled up - so...)
35BxN PxB 36PXP PXP (A king and a
pawn ending - against Miles!)



37P-N4 K-N2 38K-Q2 K-N3 39K-K3
K-N4 40K-B3 P-B5 41P-R4 K-B4
42P-R5 P-R3 White Resigns, having
run out of moves -

I might have made more of a fight of it
if I had obeyed my own rules, but I
always seem to break them ...

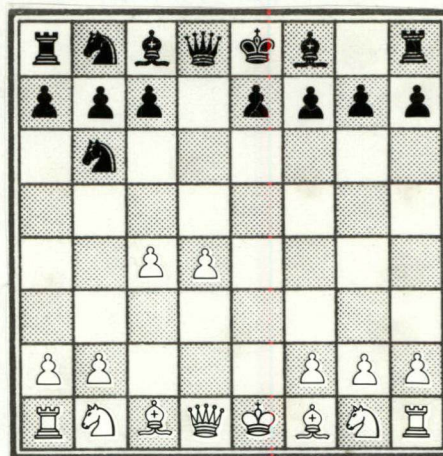
Here is another Rabbit v. Master game,
or in fact Master v. Rabbit, when I
played black against F.E.D.E. Master
R. Britton in the 3rd round of The
Regency Masters.

WHITE

Britton
(F.I.D.E. Master)
1P-K4
2PxP
3P-Q4
4P-QB4

BLACK

Josephs
Rabbit 1st Class)
P-Q4
N-KB3
NxP
N-N3



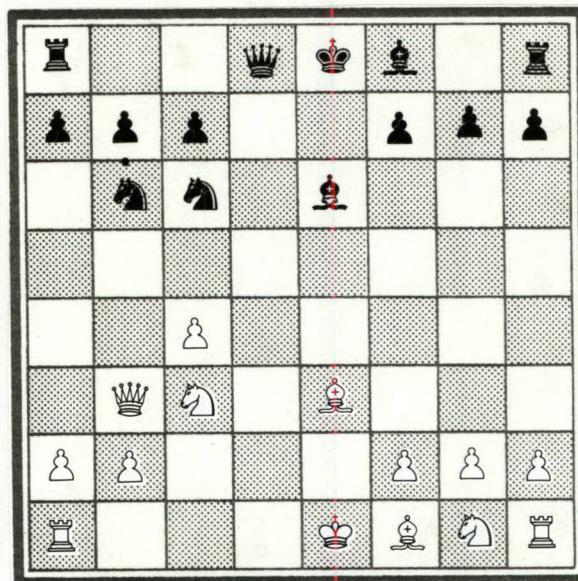
They say that this is better than 4...NKB3,
but why I don't know!

(Black has regained his pawn at the cost of
allowing white to expand in the centre. Note
on move 3 if white tries to hang on to the
pawn by 3P-QB4, black has a promising
gambit in 3...P-QB3 4PxP NxP - Ed)

5N-QB3 P-K4

Let's offer a pawn to break up his position.

6B-K3 (odd!) PxP
7BxP N-QB3
8B-K3 B-K3
9Q-N3



(White is trying to keep the queens on -
complicate against a rabbit! - but is
already in difficulty because his advanced
QBP is under fire.

9... Q-K2
10R-Q1 Q-N5

(offering a queen exchange and intensify
the attack on QB5 (c4)

11BxN

RPxN

White has to exchange off one of his bishops to save the QB pawn)

12N-B3

N-R4

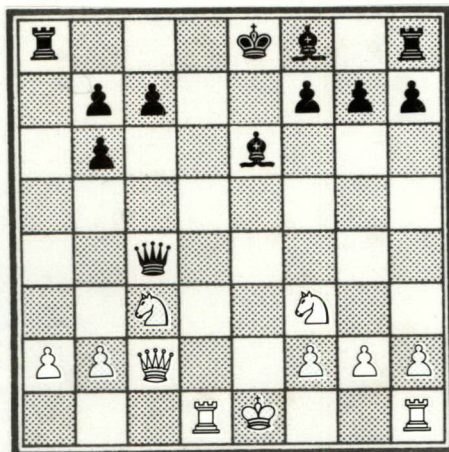
(Same old story! Black now wins a pawn)

13Q-B2

NxP

14BxN

QxB



(Black has an extra pawn, plus the two bishops, but as black's king stays in the centre, white can create complication - Ed)

15R-Q4

Q-B4

160-0

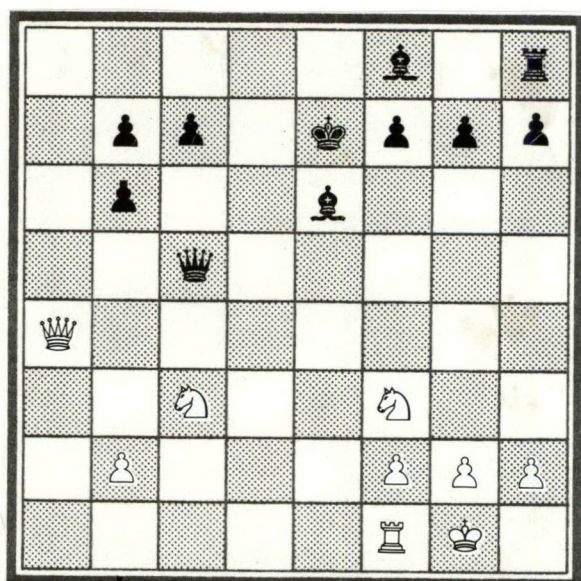
RxP

A bit rash, but 2 pawns up is two pawns up! It looks pretty too (if 17NxR QxQ!)

17R-QR4

RxR

18QxRch



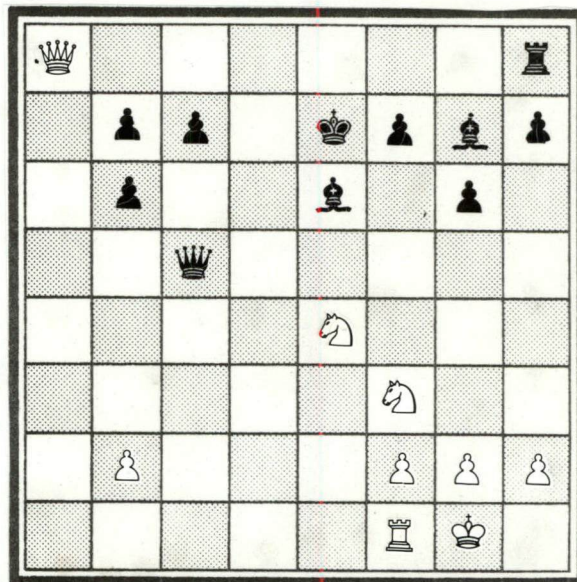
White is fighting for his life. He gets his first check in and makes the black king move up in front of the bishop, for if 18...P-B3 19Q-R8 ch and 20QxNP gets a pawn back with an attack.

19Q-R8

P-N3

20N-K4

B-N2!



(Well played! If white wins the exchange with 21QxR BxQ 22NxQ PxQ black's king is no longer under pressure, as the queens are off, and the two bishops are galloping Q side pawns are more than a match for white's rook and knight - Ed)

21QxP

White takes a pawn back and keeps some chance of attack.

21...

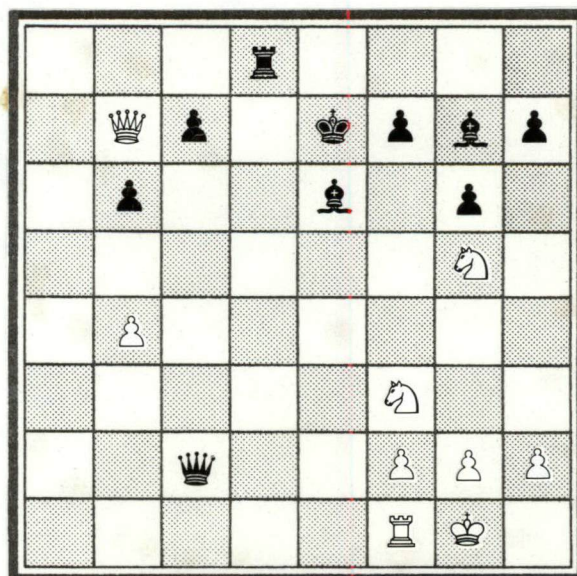
Q-B7

22P-QN4

R-Q1

Developed at last and still two pawns up.

23N(K4)-N5



Here I intended 23...R-Q8 but at that moment I was distracted by a phone call giving me the news of a burglary of my Restaurant business in London. Plus the disturbance of some 'guests' who had left the Regency Hotel without paying and I returned about ten minutes later some what disturbed and distracted. (Excuses. - Ed)

If I had played 23...R-Q8 threatening ...RxRch 25KxR Q-Q6ch and mate next move, Britton says he might well have resigned, but coming back with a fresh look I spotted ...B-Q4 forking Q and N, and after 30 seconds superficial consideration, I played

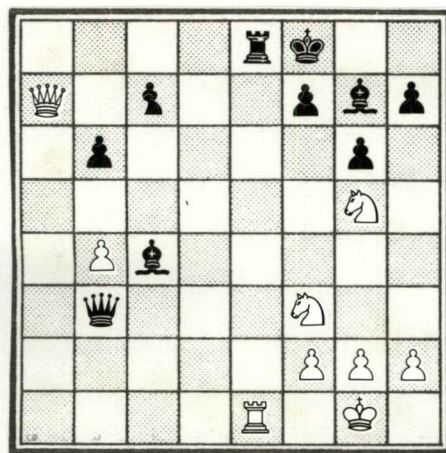
23... B-Q4
24Q-R6 B-B5
25R-K1 ch (of course)
25 - K-B1
26Q-R3 Q-N6

How pointless and stupid!

27Q-R7

Now he's really back in the game for the first time. I must lose a pawn so I panic and play

27... R-K1



28NxRPch!

and the rest is not worth playing - I'm too ashamed.

At any rate, a rabbit NEARLY beat a Master - so it shows what can be done.

Lastly, to recapitulate my rules of play for Rabbits to play Masters.

1. Stick to an Opening Repertoire you KNOW if you haven't got one try 1P-Q3 2N-KB3 3P-KN3 4B-N2 50-0 - whether you are white or black at least you get developed solidly! Five moves always the same can't be hard to learn even for 3rd class rabbits.

2. Before EVERY move you make - write it down and check all possible pins, forks, checks and captures both for yourself and your opponent - only when satisfied that you are in no danger yourself and have no better move to hand to you actually make the move.

Remember P. F. C. C. !

3. Make sure you never have more pieces on their original back row squares than your opponent - sortez les pieces and castle early if possible rather than grab pawns at the expense of development.

4. AVOID time wasting moves such as P.R3 and N-R4 unless you can PROVE that you really do gain something tangible.

5. Do not exchange a piece if it means that your opponent replaces it with another whilst yours disappears from the board - better to move another piece out to protect and develop at the same time. Do not carelessly leave pieces and pawns en prise like TAL - even if you think you can regain them later, you may be wrong!

6. PAWNS. Before you move or exchange a pawn, ask yourself does it weaken or strengthen (a) your own pawn formation (b) your opponents.

Indicators are: you strengthen when you get a passed pawn, or an out post (piece protected by a pawn that cannot be attacked by enemy pawns) and you weaken when you get doubled or isolated pawns or backward pawns on a semi open file.

7. Two bishops are usually worth at least a pawn more than two knights, but a bad bishop hemmed in by its own pawns on its own colour is worth less than a knights and should be exchanged off.

8. Rooks should always try to occupy an open file or if none, a half open file - Rooks on the seventh rank are even stronger, and rooks doubled up either on an open file or the 7th rank may often be enough to win the game on their own.

Follow these 8 rules and any Rabbit can progress from Minor to Major tournaments, and also guarantee NOT to be wiped off the board in the first 20 moves or so by ANYONE including Grandmasters.

Good Luck, and tell us how you get on ...

rr jamboree

The first RR Jamboree will take place July 3-4 1982 in London.

DAY 1 will be a simultaneous display with teaching by International Rabbit Michael Basman.

DAY 2 will be a six round quick play tournament limited to players below 135 grade.

THE SIMUL will start 10 o'clock Saturday 3rd July, and end around 1 o'clock. After a break, the games will be analysed before the group by Michael Basman, who will give individual and collective advice based on his analysis.

COST: £3 per player for whole day. Limit 20 players.

THE QUICK PLAY TOURNAMENT ; for players below 135 grade only. 6 games of half hour duration for each player (hour long game) starting 10 o'clock Sunday 4th July, ending approx six o'clock. ENTRY FEE £4; FIRST PRIZE £40 2nd- £20 3rd - £10. Cassette prizes as well.

Space is limited to 30 players, so apply early. If response is good, we will expand next year.

THE VENUE is the Casa Comminetti Restaurant, 129 Rushey Green, Catford, SE6 4AA. This is situated near the South Circular road, with regular bus services and train connections to Catford station from Charing Cross and Waterloo.

NAME _____

ADDRESS _____

TEL: _____

I wish to take part in the Simul. £3 enclosed ☐

I wish to take part in the Quick Play £4 enclosed. ☐

Write to RR 7 Billockby Close Chessington Surrey KT9 2ED

Mike Collins, P.C.C. Organiser writes specially for us.

rr postal chess

is the only P.C.C. in Britain that caters for the needs of the weaker to average chess player. In fact, the R.R.P.C.C. might best be thought of as a safety reserve for the Rabbits, because we ban the 135+ graded from joining, hence our claim to fame as a TIGER FREE ZONE.

Our principle aim is to enable R.R. readers to put into practice some of the ideas and advice that they glean from the magazine itself, by playing against other readers.

The costs aren't very high and can be roughly calculated as the cost of one second class stamp per week per opponent; or roughly $1\frac{1}{2}$ stamps per week per opponent using first class mail.

All members receive our guide to play, rules, score sheets and a small supply of re-usable window envelopes designed for the score sheets.

We also operate an elo based grade system, and annotation service.

The club is in its infancy - six months to be precise, but we already have 45 full members and a smaller number of associate members playing in three different sections.

The sections have been carefully structured such that players of near equal grade always meet each other for their initial and subsequent pairings.

Just as soon as we have enough members with results of verifiable grades, we'll be organising graded tournaments.

For the price of a pint (of beer) you can join the R.R.P.C.C. as an associate member and play in our informal section at no extra charge.

The games are casual without time limit or prizes, but to add a little zest to the games, we have come up with the following scheme.

If you beat 4 opponents in succession you earn the title of SUPER RABBIT and qualify for entry to the Club Championship; if you lose 4 in succession you become LEVERET and qualify for a stars barred style tournament.

As with all pairings, you play two games simultaneously against each opponent. Additional pairings arranged for the cost of one 2nd class stamp.

As a FULL R.R.P.C.C. MEMBER, you can enter other sections. In full swing at the moment are :-

END GAME SECTION: We choose a position from master play where the theoretical out-come is equal, and send you a diagram of the position and salient points to note. You then contest the game against an opponent as white and as black.

In subsequent pairings we allocate first positions which may be more complex or more elementary depending on your results.

PYRAMID SECTION: The pyramid is our most popular event and is best understood as a mixture of traditional club ladder and swiss.

There are three tiers - base, middle and top. All entrants start at the base and there is at least one round of play per year.

At the start of each round all entrants at the same tier are grouped in threes. Entrants then play 2 games simultaneously against the other player in the group, making a total of 4 games in all.

Promotions and relegations up and down the tiers are based on points scored during the round. Entrants gaining promotion from the top tier receive a £5 book token and qualify for entry to the Club Championship.

An annual prize for the best played game by a continuing entrant on the base tier is also awarded. Our first club championship will commence in 1986 (the same year that Voyager II reaches Uranus). However, on line for this year are:

- postal team match starting in April
- new members tournament starting June
- and an R.R.P.C.C. congress probably in July at a London venue.

Full details of the R.R.P.C.C. will be sent to you if you write to:-

audio news

Audio Chess News is a new bi-monthly magazine to keep you up to date in the latest happenings in the Audio Chess world. Issue No 1 features reviews of 'Thor' and Scheveningen tapes, 'My openings at Bedworth' by Tim Wall, 'Swindles' by D. Cooper, issue No 2 contains 'Notes on the Polish Defence' and 'The opening that never won a tournament game' by M. Basman. '1...b6 at the British Under 18s' by C. Archer-Lock. The magazine is marvellous and only £3.50 for a year's subscription, or 60p for specimen copy, post free.



The Chess Centre

3 HARCOURT STREET, LONDON W.1. 01-402 5393



CHESS SETS, CASSETTES, CHESS BOARDS, BOOKS, MAGAZINES THE LOT .

ASSESSING QUALITY

The strongest impression left by a game of chess is the result. Whether he won, lost or drew, the final score makes an emotional imprint on the player which will effect him for a long period of time.

Yet despite the impact, the result of the game tells very little about it. Granted one player won, but the result of Karpov v. Rabbit and strong rabbit v. weak rabbit will be the same, but will not reflect the wide difference between the two winners.

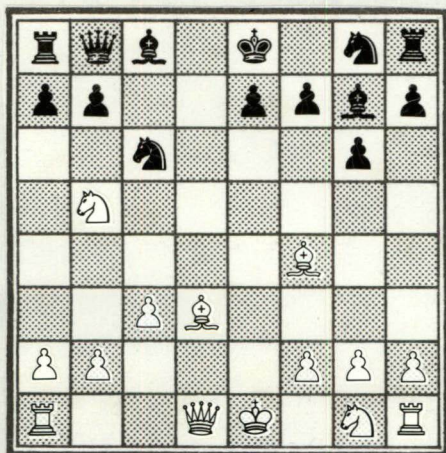
So what we need is some more precise measure of the quality of play in a game, if we are to gain the greatest benefit from competitive play.

The analysis of games presented here will once again divide moves into three main types - the material, the tactical and the positional. These areas, or levels, have been discussed in RR16, so if you are a new subscriber you had better read that issue first.

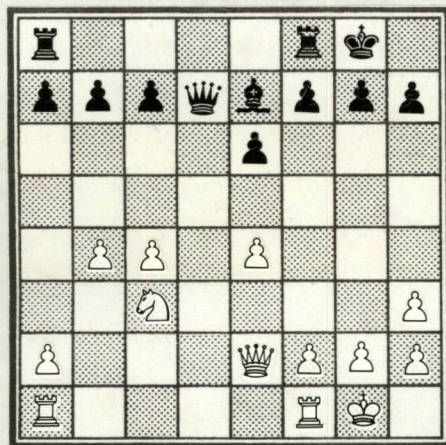
Our analysis further sub-divides material, positional and tactical moves into three classes each, according to the severity of error or excellence of move. Because we are dealing here mainly with rabbit games (here loosely defined as below 160 grade) the analysis will tend to emphasise errors more than good moves. As players become stronger, certain errors fall away, and other moves are very hard even to classify as mistakes. You just get statements like "probably" and "dubious" cropping up the higher you go, meaning a definite conclusion is difficult to reach.

We shall start first right at the bottom, with the most basic type of error, very common in novice games and not entirely absent in games of players up to 120 grade - this is the MATERIAL error.

Here is an example of the worst form of material error.



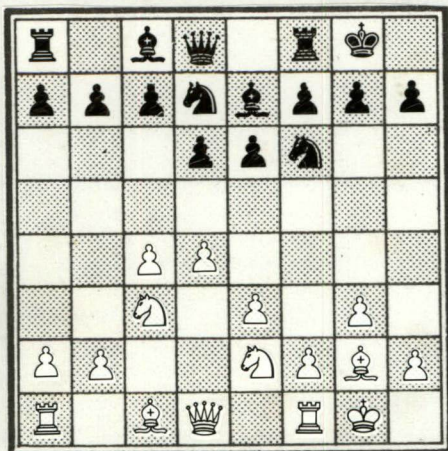
White has just moved his bishop to KB4, attacking the black queen, but he overlooks that his own piece is undefended and black just takes it off. Faults like this, where there is a straight forward capture of material - a piece at least - we shall call M3 - (which means Material error, 3rd degree).



Slightly less severe is this example.

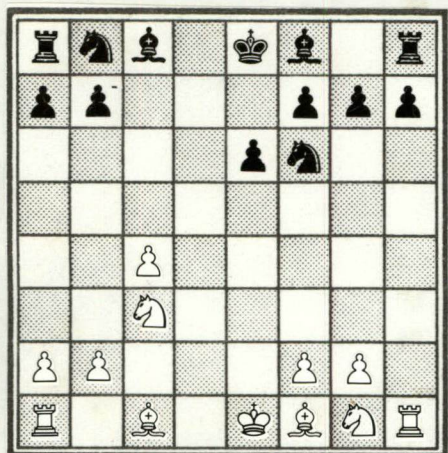
White plays P-KR3 but overlooks that a pawn is en prise - same sort of oversight, but not so serious - only a pawn was lost, and unless your opponent is above grade 100, this mistake should not prove decisive. We'll call it M2 -

At M1-. we get the more complex form of material error, and in many cases this will shade off into the tactical error. Let's give an example.



Here there are several pieces defending Q5, and several attacking. Black does not count properly and plays 1...P-Q4 nevertheless, and loses a pawn after 2PxP PxP 3NxP NxN 4BxN

Now we come to the TACTICAL level. You remember our definition of tactics? How does one define tactics? Well, there is not an all encompassing definition, but for our own purposes, we have called tactics the double or multiple attack.



For example, in this diagram white plays 1N-QN5. What does black do? He doesn't see it - plays his own plan of 1...N-QB3 and falls into the crudest form of double attack by N-QB7 ch, which attacks both king and rook. This we would class as T3-

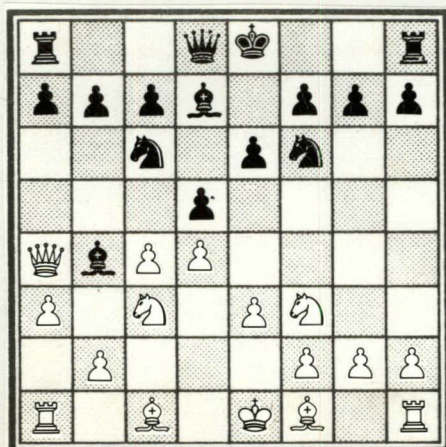
If we look at the various tactical manoeuvres, such as the pin, the skewer, the fork, we can see the double attack in action. Other ideas such as discovered attack, overloading, deflection are not so easy to categorise, but they are all clearly more complex than the straight line examples we get in Material Chess.

Other types of tactics involve the exposing and mating of the enemy king, or the use of the enemy king position for winning material. All these things are tactical, but

they may not involve a multiple attack. So do not limit the idea of tactics solely to that of a double or multiple attack.

What is particular to both tactical and material chess is that we are usually dealing in concrete moves and tangible amounts of material - loss and gains of pawns, pieces, queens and kings.

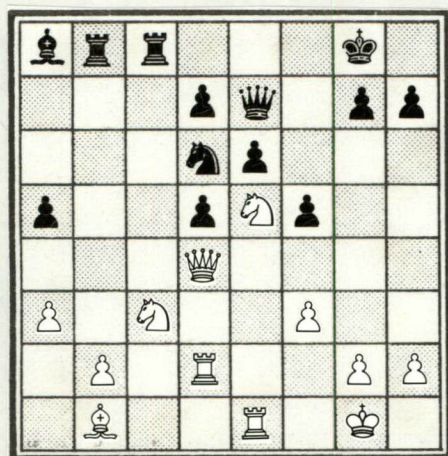
Having seen a T3- type of error, let's look at a more complex one.



Here white plays 1P-QR3, and black moves 1...BxN ch. What is wrong with this sequence? Both sides made T2- errors; middle range tactical errors. They saw that after 1P-QR3, black could play 1...NxQP, because there is a discovered attack against the white queen, so that white cannot answer 2PxN.

However, they thought 1...NxQP was unplayable because of the answer 2QxB. But deeper tactical analysis reveals the fork, 2...N-B7 ch, winning the white queen.

How would one classify a T1- tactical error?



Possibly from one of my own games, an example will be helpful.

Against Tisdall in the London International 1982, though a piece down the black central pawns form a powerful barrier keeping white at bay. I (black) decided to go for the end game by playing 1...N-B5, thinking that something like 2NxN RxN 3Q-R7 Q-B4 ch 4QxQ RxQ might occur, with reasonable survival chances for black.

Yet 1...N-B5 was catastrophically punished. Can you see how?

Well, if you did you've no business reading this magazine.

Tisdall played 2NxN RxN 3NxQP! and all the tactical variations work against black. For example, 3...RxQ 4NxQch K-B2 5RxR; or 3...BxN 4QxB! (making use of the pin on the queen file) PxQ 5RxQ. Black's pawns are shattered and he has now no compensation for his lost piece.

Black's move 1...N-B5 should be classed as a T1- - a high level tactical error. And white deserves credit for finding the refutation - his 3NxQP would be a T1+ move (the plus sign showing that it's a strong move).

POSITIONAL CHESS

Now we can look at the positional arena. As you will know (if you read issue 16), positional chess differs sharply from both tactical and material chess in that we are not netting material. We are just placing our pieces and pawns in the most effective way. Now a well placed piece has a value, but this value is constantly shifting, and is certainly rarely worth more than a pawn - so the positional world is more subtle, more changeable than the other two.

It might be thought that positional play is less important than the other areas, because immediate gains are not made on it. But in fact this is not true. One cannot rely on one's opponent leaving pieces en prise, and also from a bad position, the tactics will tend to work against one, so the only sure way to win is to try to obtain the superior position.

For example, at the famous Battle of Hastings, we are told that William had a bad position against Harold who was on the top of the hill. Rather than attack and exhaust his men, William first improved his position (in this case by running away, causing Harold to run after him). When Harold was at the bottom of the hill the armies were positionally equal, and then William began to fight, turning a material advantage to victory. (Harold's men were actually not at full strength due to having tired themselves out at a previous battle in Stamford Bridge).

It might be objected that William had not played positionally, he'd just tricked Harold, however, the important fact here is that William did not fight until he had obtained a positional equality.

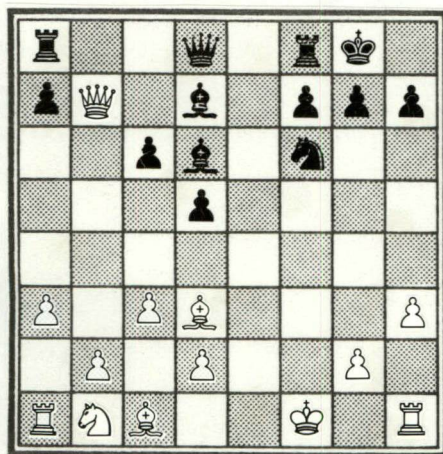
THE IDEAS

What sort of positional ideas do we know in chess? There are those related to pieces, ensuring them good lines of action; to the pawns, concerning control of territory, defence of possible weak points and weaknesses in themselves. In the opening, positional chess is concerned with the effective use of time, because the pieces start off in a muffled and suffocated situation, and must try to arise and mobilise as rapidly as possible.

Lastly, there is the position of the king, his safety or exposure - the only positional factor which is worth a pawn at least and of course, depending on the position - may be worth far more - a piece, or a queen even. We shall return to this factor later. It is almost a category of its own, straddling positional and tactical worlds and causing discomfort to the tactician (who wishes there were no defending pawns around the enemy king) and theoretician (who dreams of the 100% safe king position).

As before we shall start at the bottom with the worst forms of positional error and gradually move up into areas where good moves are made.

First P3 - Take a look at this diagram.



In this position we can see white has made several positional mistakes. He has moved his queen far out, leaving others undeveloped at home. He has strangled his own queen side development by playing moves like P-QR3, PQB3 and B-Q3. He has allowed the pawn cover to be removed from his king in the centre but has not taken steps to remove the king away from the central zone.

Look now at black's game, where the black is safe behind pawns in the corner. All black's minor pieces are off the back rank and control a lot of squares. Black's queen and rook have been kept back for the time being, but they are ready to come into action, the rook by using the central king file and the queen along any of the diagonal and files.

White has a poor game, and will not survive long, particularly because his king is exposed.

If we went over this game by white, we would undoubtedly find many positional errors which led up to the present situation.

Moving upwards, the positional errors become far harder to distinguish. There are usually reasons in favour of making any move, and it is only bad because there are more reasons against than for it.

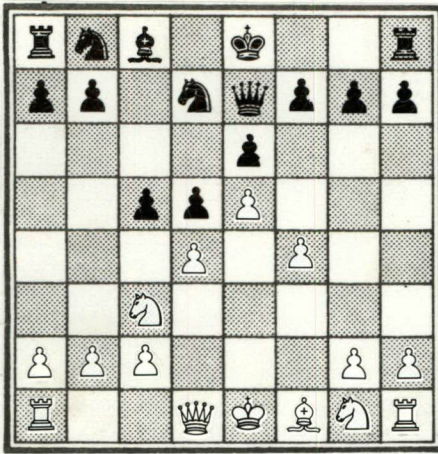
Take this position:

Here black has just played ...PQ B4.

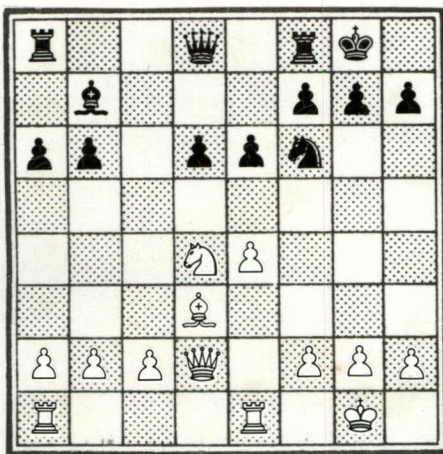
Is this a good move ?

In its favour we have the positional idea of attacking the opponent's centre and opening the QB file. Those are positional plusses.

But the drawback of the move is that white plays 2N-QN5, threatening to win the exchange with 3N-B7, when black defends this with 2...N-N3, white moves in 3N-Q6ch, disturbing the black king and sinking a supported knight right into the heart of black's game. These factors outweigh the advantages, so I class 1...P-QB4 as a P2- (fairly serious positional error).



Another example of a P2- error might be this position.



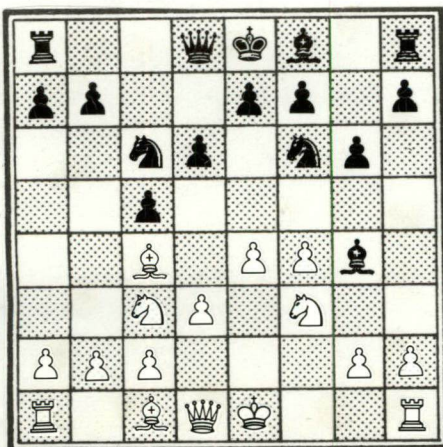
Here black plays 1...P-K4, attacking the knight at Q4 and driving it away from its post at Q4.

Yet the move is not good because the knight moves further forward to KB5, menacing the pawn at Q6 and the black king side.

However, were the position only slightly changed, 1...P-K4 would become quite a good move rather than a bad one. For example, place the black bishop at QB1 (c8) and the black queen at QB2 (c7). Here after 1...P-K4 2N-B5 BxN 3PxN P-Q4 black may have given up a bishop for a knight, but his pawn centre move than compensates for this.

What about a P1- type error? In judging errors of this type we must be always prepared to accept the judgement is so fine that the move may not be an error at all; so we would make no mark. Or looking at the position from a different point of view the move played may turn out to be positionally strong after all.

Take this position.



Here black played 1...B-KN5 2P-KR3 BxN 3QxB N-Q5 4Q-B2

What do you make of black's play, particularly the move 1...B-KN5, which started it all?

Black has developed a piece and exchanged a well placed white knight (+). He gave up a bishop for a knight in a position that is not yet blocked (-).

In removing the knight at KB3 he has posted his own knight strongly at Q5 and gained time by attacking the white queen, which has had to move twice (+).

Due to this assessment, the player of this game decided that the manoeuvre begun with 1...B-KN5 was a good one(P1+).

Nevertheless, I consider that 1...B-KN5 was a positional error. The white game is now free and the white queen is well placed on KB2.

White is now ready with a pawn roller attack by P-KN4/and P-KB5. He has the two bishops.

Because the assessments are so hard to make should not discourage Rabbit Review readers. Rather it should give them the clue to that age old unanswered question "Why is that fellow better than me?" He's better because he can perceive positional differences and performs adequately on tactical and material levels. And by working on his and other games, assessing and judging them constantly, the rabbit can also raise his play.

We are now ready to set up a rudimentary table of values, which would look like this.

Type of Move	M3-	M2-	M1-						
			T3-	T2-	T1-			T2+	T1+
					P3-	P2-	P1-		P2+
									P1+
Score	-7	-6	-5	-4	-3	-2	-1	+1	+2
								+3	

This table means: the material errors are most serious, because they do so much damage to a position, and for these the most points are deducted (-7, -6, -5). Then the tactical and the least harmful are positional errors. There is room for good tactical and positional moves too!

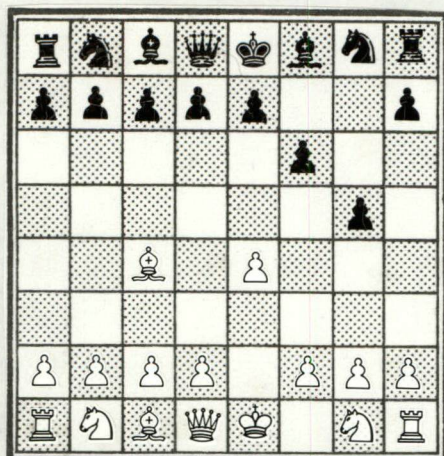
Note two things: The overlapping of M1- and T3-; both receive the same subtraction of points. The meaning is that a slight material error is as bad as a crude tactical error, and often they appear to merge into one another. There is also overlapping between slight tactical and crass positional error. The reasoning behind this is that a bad positional error may be as harmful to a position as a tactical mistake.

There are no plus scores for 'good material moves'. They do not exist. If your opponent leaves a piece en prise, you take it. Great skill is not required to do so. Therefore, material chess only appears on the negative scale.

There still needs to be some additions to our table before we set it clanking into action on some poor rabbit's game. This concerns the king. As stated, king safety is a positional feature but quite different to all other positional factors because the king is so valuable. Furthermore, exploitation of an exposed king is usually a tactical matter.

Let us take an example here.

The game 1P-K4 P-KB4 2B-B4 P-KN4



Now here we see that black's pawn moves have not helped his development. His first move denied the knight at KN1 a square, and his second, though allowing the bishop out, did not promise any wonderful diagonals: because both at KN2 and KR3 she would be blocked by her own pawns.

These moves would be in themselves positional errors, but what makes them serious is that they expose the king and allow a mate in one by 3Q-R5. Such mistakes which as it were leave the king en prise should be classed as very low material errors (M3- at least!)

Now for two more examples.

DIAGRAM 1

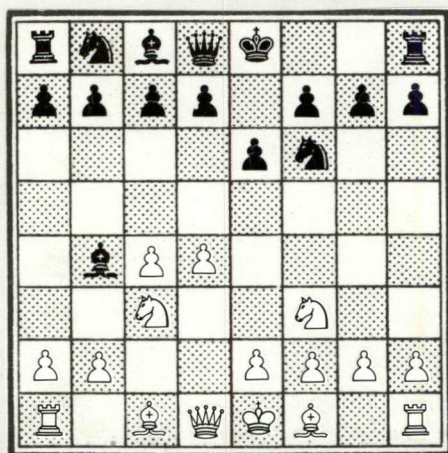
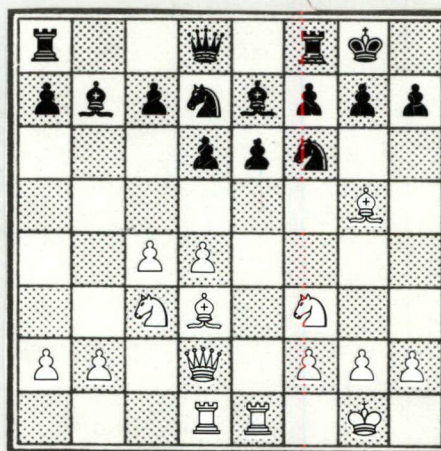


DIAGRAM 2



In both these cases black can double the white pawns by 1...BxN, but in the first example there is nothing more involved. In the second, the defect to white's position is enhanced because it happens near the white king, and thus weakens his defences.

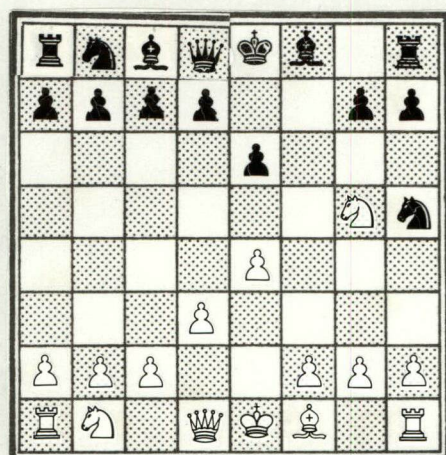
The scoring for the second example should, therefore, reflect not simply a positional move, but king exposure as well.

Therefore, the table above should include an 'X' factor ('X' standing for exposure). You should insert the Xs in the top row thus:

X3-	very bad exposure	-7 (=M3-)
X2-	medium exposure	-4 (=T2-)
X1-	slight exposure	-2 (P2-)
X+	good attacking move against enemy king	+2 (=T1/P2+)

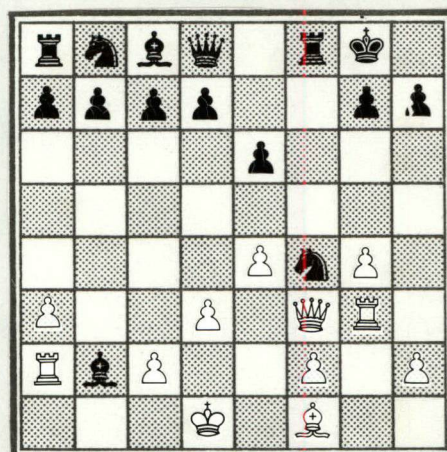
Now that we have assembled all the bits, let us try to assess the quality of some games. We'll start with a whopper.

1P-Q3 N-KB3
 2B-N5 N-R4
 3N-KB3 P-KB3
 4P-K4 PxB
 5NxNP P-K3



6P-KN4 N-B5
 7R-KN1 QxN
 8R-N3 B-N5 ch
 9N-B3 Q-Q1
 10Q-B3 0-0
 11P-QR3 BxN ch

12K-Q1 BxNP
 13R-R2



13... N-Q4
 14RxB RxQ
 15RxB N-B6 ch
 16K-Q2 N-R5
 17R-N5 P-QR3
 18R-KR5 P-KN3
 19R-K5 P-Q3
 20R-QR5 N-N3
 21R-B6 QxR
 22P-KB4 QxP ch

and black won.

What did you make of that? My assessment was like this.

Co-
 Totals efficient

WHITE			M3-		M3-	M3-		M3-		T3-		M3-	M2-		
			-7		-7	-7		-7		-5		-7	-6	-46	-2.09
BLACK	P2-	P2-		M3-			P3-		T1+		P2-			-15	-0.68
	-2	-2		-7			-3		+1		-2				
MOVE No.	2	3	4	5	6	7	9	12	13	14	17-19	21	22	22	

The large number of material errors by white show that this is a beginner's game. Black also makes some errors, losing a piece at move 5, but he engineers a nice discovered attack at move 13 which catches the white queen unawares. You'll note that though black is able to combine a little and capture pieces, even in the final position he has yet to think about the development of his queen side. Hence the deduction for poor positional play on moves 17-19, when he chases the white rook with pawns instead of bringing his queen side pieces out.

Assessing a game in this way shows us what sort of instruction would be suitable for each player. In white's case, this should concentrate on showing him how to spot attacks on his own and enemy men. Black, on the other hand, is already able to move up to study simple tactics and basic positional ideas.

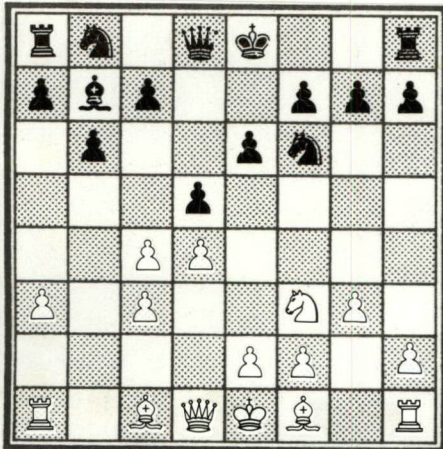
The coefficient in the last column is for the mathematically minded. It is arrived at by dividing the total score for the game by the number of moves played.

Our second game is more closely fought. I will analyse it with you, and at the end you should try to construct a score table in the same way as the last game.

1P-QB4 P-QN3
2N-QB3 P-K3
3N-KB3 B-N2
4P-KN3 B-N5

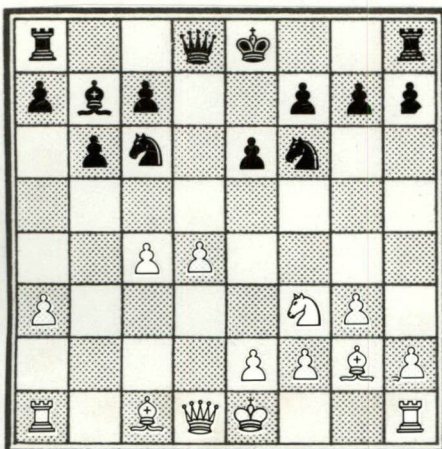
(I prefer 4...P-KN4 - MJB)

5P-QR3 BxN
6NPxB N-KB3
7P-Q4 P-Q4



Having just doubled white's pawns it is not logical to undouble them by playing 7...P-Q4. Better would be to fix them with ...P-QB4

8PxP NxP
9P-QB4 N-KB3
10B-KN2 N-QB3



Though apparently an active move, black should run into trouble now if white responds with 11N-K5, taking advantage of the pin on the knight at QB3. If black then answers ...NxN 12BxB R-QN1 13PxN QxQch 14KxQ N-N5 15B-B6ch leaves white a piece up after a complex tactical sequence. Instead of 10...N-QB3

black should have played 10...QN-Q2, which blocks neither his bishop nor his QB pawn and prepares ...P-QB4.

11 B-KN5?

White in turn blunders. Not only does he miss 11N-K5, but this move should itself lose a pawn by 11...NxQP!

12QxN QxQ 13NxQ BxB

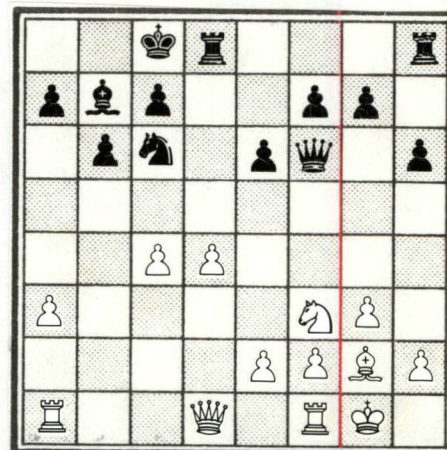
11... P-KR3?

Another tactical error throws the ball back to white.

12 BxN QxB?

12...PxP was better, because once again white can play the move 13 N-K5. If black then responds with 13...N-R4 14Q-R4ch forces the black king to move.

130-0 0-0-0



Black plays an active game, putting pressure down the d file against white's d pawn, but exposing his own king a little.

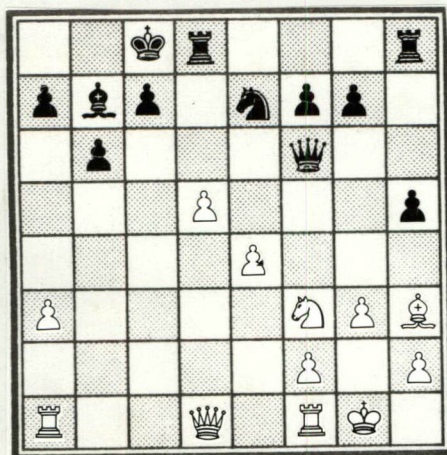
14P-Q5 PxP?

This is suspect as it opens the QB file against the black king. Possible is 14...N-K4 or 14...N-K2

15 PxP N-K2

16P-K4 P-KR4

17B-R3 ch



Criminal. This check only drives the black king to a safer spot. Better to put major pieces immediately on the QB file.

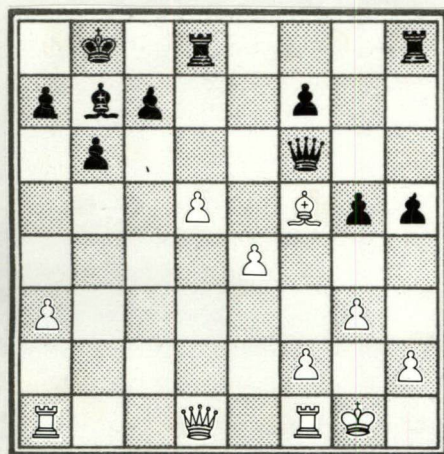
17... K-N1
18N-R4

Another awful move. White's play would not be so detrimental if it were not taking place in the vicinity of his own king ... In fact, he is simply asking black to advance pawns to break up his position.

18... P-KN4!
19N-B5

This is the lesser evil, as both 19N-N2 and 19N-B3 lose a piece to ...P-N5

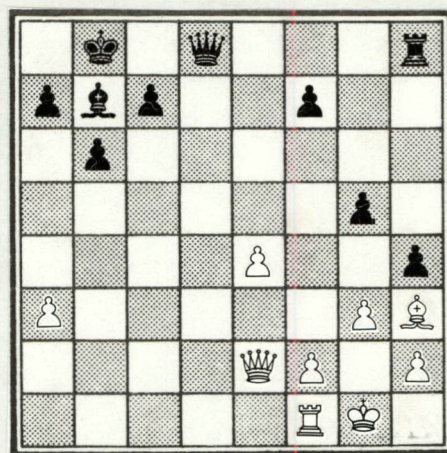
19... NxN
20BxN



20... BxP!

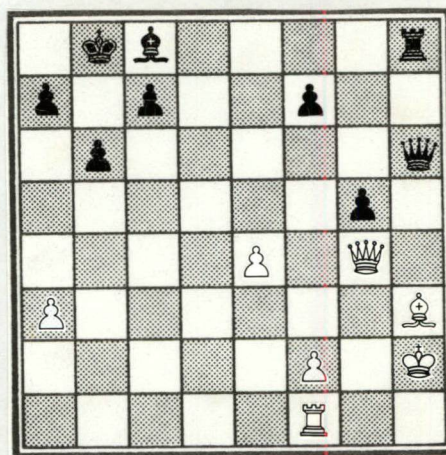
In this way black wins a pawn, because 21PxB is answered by QxB.

21Q-B3 B-N2
22QR-Q1 Q-K2
23RxRch QxR
24Q-K2 P-R5
25B-R3



This is terrible. White is trying to get his bishop back to KN2 to defend the king side, but overlooks a simple discovered attack 25...PxP. White cannot then recapture the pawn, because his bishop is under fire. Thus white loses another pawn. His situation is worsened by the fact that his king is now exposed further.

25... PxP
26Q-N4 PxPch
27KxP Q-Q3ch
28K-N1 Q-R3
29K-R2 B-B1



A fine move which wins a piece due to the pin on the bishop at KR3.

30Q-N3 QxBch
(30... BxB would have won more material.
31QxQ BxQ
32K-N3 ?

And white resigned at the same time. He should have played 32R-K1, but would anyway have been a piece and two pawns behind.

NOW CONSTRUCT A SCORE TABLE BASED ON THE ABOVE ANALYSIS BEFORE CONTINUING.

SCORE TABLE

	Totals											Coefficient	
WHITE			T2-		T2-		P3-	T2-		X3-			
			-4		-4		-3	-4		-7		-22	-0.68
BLACK	P2-	T2-	T2-	T2-		P1-		X+	T2+		T1+		
	-2	-4	-4	-4		-1		+2	+2		+1	-10	-0.31
MOVE No.	7	10	11	12	13	14	17	18	20	25	29	32	

Whereas in the previous game we had several serious material errors, there is a marked absence of them here. This already shows that both white and black are stronger than their counter parts in the first encounter. Perhaps you spotted that the coefficient for white in this games is the same as that for black in the previous encounter! But this does not mean they are equal players, but that we have marked the first game more leniently than this one. And so we should; what to one player is a medium range tactical blow becomes a "brilliant stroke" to a weaker player, because it is that much harder for him to see.

In this game the worst error was white's at move 25, when he was only a pawn down (as opposed to the queen and several pieces advantage to black in game 1 by move 20). White's 25B-R3 loses another pawn and would be normally classed as M1- or T3-; but as it leads to the kings chronic exposure a better scoring is X3-.

Both sides make several middle range tactical errors, but it is white's totally misguided moves 17 and 18 which do him real damage. Though these are positional errors, once again they are worse because they help black's king side attack.

Black plays the game actively throughout, and has a good idea of what he should be aiming for, but his play is slipshod and a stronger opponent would have seen the moves 11N-K5! and 13N-K5!

CATEGORIES

One problem in the analysis is that you may have noticed is the assignment of the correct category. This is not always a simple task! For example, is black's tenth move ...N-QB3, a positional or a tactical error?

Positionally it develops a knight towards the centre, so it should be okay. However, the knight blocks the diagonal of the bishop at QN2, and also the pawn at QB2. Had black played 10...QN-Q2, he would have been able to follow up with ...P-QB4 later.

Yet these considerations do not class the move ...N-QB3 as bad, because on Q2 it would have been in the way on the queen file as well, whereas after ...N-QB3 black is threatening to use the queen file aggressively by ...Q-Q2 and 0-0-0.

It is due to tactical reasons that the move 10...N-QB3 is dubious, as we have shown that 11N-K5 would have been very troublesome. So 10...N-QB3 (T2-).

Later on we examine white's 18th move N-R4. Is this move bad because it shifts the knight away from the centre? Because white had better moves in attacking along the QB file? Or because it increased the danger to the white monarch by encouraging black to advance his king side pawns forward? Probably none of these reasons was the most serious drawback to the move, which was that it led to a forced loss of material involving a tactical idea. (That is 18...P-KN4 and 20...BxP!) Hence, 18N-R4 is T2-, rather than P3- or X2.

YOUR OWN WORK

Now I shall give the reader two more games to analyse, this time entirely by himself. The work should be done in this order.

1. First play over the games, covering up the moves and trying to guess them in advance.
2. Then write your analysis to the games as I have done earlier in this article.
3. Construct a score chart for each game.

The games have been analysed by the R.R. experts, but you will not find them in this issue. To obtain our analyses, write to:

Rabbits Review, 7 Billockby Close, Chessington, Surrey KT9 2ED
enclosing 20p stamp, and we will send them to you. There's a test of keenness!

The most difficult problem the reader will run up against is his own ability. Though these games are of players grade 100-120, and thus easier to understand than those of masters and grandmasters, your analysis is unlikely to be anything like as good as that done by a master. But that is the name of the game we are playing. By doing your own work, and then comparing it with master analyses, you have a chance of improvement. A pep talk, to persuade you you are a great player when you're not, is no use to you, and Rabbits Review does not go in for that sort of thing.

GAME 1

1P-QB4	P-QB4
2N-QB3	N-QB3
3P-K4	P-K4
4N-B3	P-Q3
5B-K2	N-B3
6P-QN3	B-K2
7P-Q3	0-0
80-0	B-N5
9N-KR4	BxB
10QxB	N-Q5
11Q-Q1	NxKP
12PxN	BxN
13N-K2	N-B3
14B-K3	B-K2
15Q-B2	Q-B1
16KR-Q1	P-B4
17P-B4	N-N5
18Q-Q2	PxKP
19P-QR3	N-Q6
20N-N3	PxBP
21BxKBP	NxB
22NxP	Q-B3
23R-K1	QR-K1
24P-N3	N-N3
25QR-Q1	N-K4
26Q-Q5 ch	

0 - 1

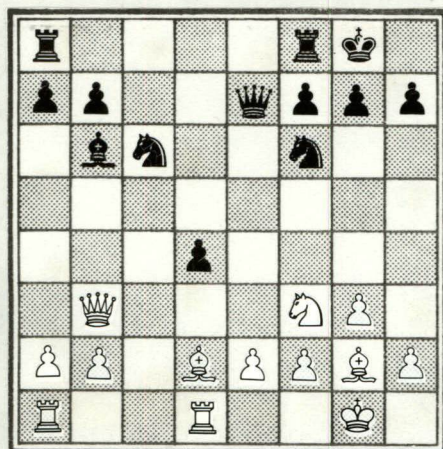
GAME 2

1P-K4	P-Q4
2PxP	QxP
3N-QB3	Q-Q1
4N-B3	P-KN3
5P-Q4	B-N2
6P-KR3	N-KR3
7BxN	BxB
8B-B4	0-0
9N-K2	B-N2
10P-KR4	P-KR4
11Q-Q2	P-QB3
120-0-0	N-Q2
13K-N1	N-N3
14B-N3	N-Q4
15N-B4	B-R3
16BxN	PxB
17QR-K1	P-K3
18P-KN3	Q-Q3
19R-K2	P-N3
20KR-K1	B-R3
21R-K5	KB-N2
22NxNP	PxN
23RxKP	Q-Q2
24R-K7	Q-Q1
25N-N5	B-R3
26Q-K3	B-N4
27Q-K6ch	K-R1
28R-R7	mate

positional study

In R.R. 16 we gave you 4 positions to analyse. Here we shall look at two of them.

Diagram 1



Material is even, and there is one direct threat in the position against the pawn at K2.

Both kings look quite safe.

Development of the pieces by both sides is good.

The knights are developed near the centre and do not block pawns which wish to move forward.

Both white bishops have good action, and though the bishop at Q2 is exposed to the move 6N-K5, it can retreat to K1 and preserve itself.

The back ranks have been cleared by the removal of the kings and queens, and the rooks have access to a choice of several files. Both sides have almost

'completed' their development; by this we would mean - pieces are developed in this order - 1) knights, 2) bishops 3) kings (by castling) 4) queens, 5) rooks.

This is not a rigid rule - you will find hundreds of exceptions. But usually the rooks are the last to come into action, because all the other pieces must be cleared off the back rank and the king castled before they can come to possible open files.

This is the meaning of the phrase "Development takes as long as is needed to connect rooks".

Based on the preceding analyses, white's 'normal' positional move would be 1QR-B1, and black would reply by bringing his rooks to QB1, Q1 and K1.

Tactical analysis shows that 1QR-B1 is indeed possible, because 1...QxP in reply is bad because of 2R-K1 Q-R3 3B-KB1 trapping the queen.

Having looked at the possibilities for the rooks, we can come to the queens. These also have to be developed according to the principle - MAXIMUM EFFECT, MINIMUM EXPOSURE.

Both queens have come off the back rank, which helps the rooks. To help themselves, they do not need to advance too far, and black's queen has placed herself on the second rank.

Here however, she can still be in danger of attack by other long range pieces such as the rooks and bishops. She has guarded against rook attack by placing herself on a file with an enemy pawn on it. This is better than going to QB2 (an open file) or Q2 where she may be in danger due to a concealed pin (for example by B-K3).

There is still a possibility of a diagonal attack, but black knight at QB3 prevents white's B-QN4 move.

White's queen has moved a rank up to QN3. She has very good scope, and no danger from rook attack. There is no danger from attack on the diagonals either - white has exchanged off the relevant black bishop, and so can go to a white square with impunity.

There is just a possibility of a knight attack, by 1...N-QR4, but white has put paid to that by putting his bishop at Q2; after 1...N-QR4 2BxN BxB3 NxQP white wins a pawn.

Now we shall discuss the balance of minor pieces. Here white has the advantage of two bishops against bishop and knight, and we must decide, is this an advantage here? We know, after all, that there are many cases where the knight is better than the bishop. Is this one of them?

The simple methods for deciding this is to see (1) if the bishops have clear diagonals, (2) if the knights have advanced, protected out posts. Most important in the assessment is to look at the central pawn position. If it is blocked, the knights could be good, and the bishops will have limited diagonals.

Studying the positions, we can see that the centre is almost entirely clear of pawns, so that in this open position the bishops should be better. It is true that the knights are well placed, but they do not have the chance of advanced secure out posts (the square K5 (e4) is only a semi-permanent out post for black's knight).

Now we have decided that white has the better of the minor piece bargain, take a look at the bishops. Because black is missing a white squared bishop, it is those squares that white should be able to dominate. White has already been able to post the queen aggressively, and the diagonals KR1-QR1 and QR2-KN8 will be tender spots for black.

The remaining black bishop at QN3 is well placed though it is limited by the pawn at Q5.

This brings us to the pawn structure. The role of the king side pawns is fairly clear. They provide shelter and will not need to be moved. The black pawn at Q5 is isolated, and exposed on an open file. It will need protection by pieces, but as black is able to do so fairly easily by natural piece placing (Bishop at QN3, knight at QB3, rook at Q1) we should look at the advantages of the pawn, which cramps whites game and prevents the pawn at K2 from advancing to K3, where it would be protected by another pawn.

To understand the main disadvantage of the pawn at Q5, you must understand an important idea about pawns which is

THEIR IMMOBILITY

Pawns move forward but attack diagonally. Because they do not attack forward they often have difficulty in moving forwards. When a master looks at a pawn (like the one at Q5 (d4) he thinks of it as a fixed object, whereas the other pieces on the board give him an impression of mobility. The pawn has got as far as it can, and any further advance will now lead to capture.

A pawn of this type bears a strong resemblance to a bishop - like a bishop it attacks diagonally, and like a bishop it is chained to squares of one colour. However, the pawn is not chained to 32 squares like a bishop - it may be chained to one square alone! What a terrible fate for a poor footsoldier.

This is why the idea of 'bad bishops' only refers to the pawn structure. If a pawn is stuck on one square, and cannot move forward, then it's bad news for the bishop that wants to travel through the square the pawn is on.

EXPLOITATION OF EXPOSURE

We have mentioned that all pieces seem well developed and that none appears exposed, however, we have left one piece, and one pawn in our discussion. Which are they?

Exposure is defined as attack by a lesser piece upon a piece of greater value, and also attack from a direction in which the given piece does not move. In this position by 1P-QR4! White takes advantage of the bishop at QN3.

If black could now reply 1...P-QR4 he would be all right, but this fails tactically to 2QxB. So black must allow the pawn's further advance.

The game continued 1...N-K5 2B-K1 QR-Q1 3P-R5 B-B4.

The bishop is now forced to an open file, where it is in more danger than on QN3.

4P-R6

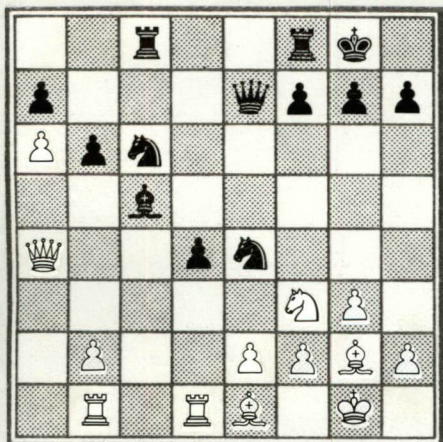
What is the meaning of this? White is undermining the knight at QB3, and more important, enhancing his control of the white squares. Continuing for analogy of pawns as mini-bishops, by knocking out the pawn at QN7 white destroys an important lynch pin.

However, it appears that by playing here 3...P-QN3 black can support his bishop at QB4, and though white has greater white square control, black is very well off in the squares of the other colour. He has set up a chain leading from QR2 to Q5 and white's rooks seem powerless against this.

However, the exposure of black's pieces is not at an end. By playing 5Q-R4 (attacking the undefended knight at QB3) QR-B1 6QR-QN1 white once again exploits black's exposed forces, because he threatens to play now 7P-QN4 which break the barricade on the QB file, and also weakens the defences of the pawn at Q5.

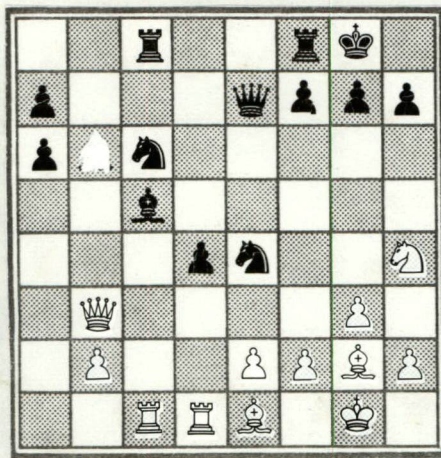
That position deserves a diagram.

Diagram 2



In fact after 3P-R6 black did not play ...P-QN3 but captured, and now white made an unusually fine attacking move. Instead of the automatic 4RxB, he moved 4QR-B1, taking advantage of the poor black pieces lined up on the QB file. Black answered 4...R-QB1 and white moved 5N-R4

Diagram 3



This is a classic demonstration of exposure in action. At least five black pieces find themselves vulnerably placed and white won the exchange after 5...B-N3 - 6N-B5 Q-K4 7BxN QxB 8N-Q6 forking queen and rook.

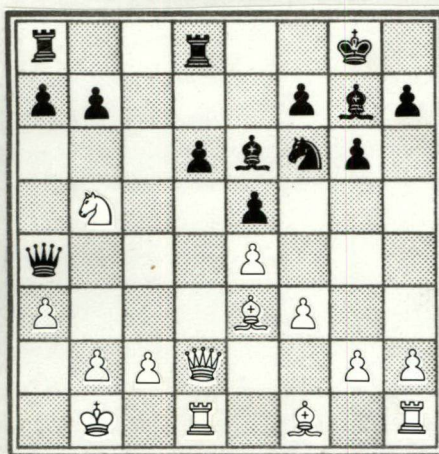
The player of the white pieces was Emmanuel Lasker, a world champion and black was the German champion S. Tarrasch. There was a fundamental distinction in the approach of the two players, in that Tarrasch always preached rapid development and freedom of pieces. But Lasker's play showed that these concepts were inadequate in themselves, and mainly by applying the principle of exposure he caused black's game to creak at the seams until it finally cracked.

If you look at this game analysed in Chernev's book 'The 62 Most Instructive Games of Chess Ever Played', you will see his account stressed the liability of the isolated pawn. To quote: "He begins by a direct attack on the pawn. If that attack does not succeed he attacks the pieces protecting the pawn. If that effort is repulsed he attacks the pawns that protect the pieces that protect the isolated pawn."

This is a valid way of viewing the position, though my analysis fills out the picture by adding extra concepts. (Play on squares of one colour; exposure of pieces; the idea of pawns as small bishops).

POSITION No. 2

Diagram 4



Material balance is equal.

There is a direct threat of 1NxQP, though this fails tactically due to 1...B-KB1 exploiting the pin along the queen file.

The kings are both castled, upon opposite sides, which means that the enemy pawns are forced to advance against them to open up lines. White's king looks more exposed - there is an open QB file and a black queen and bishop placed near the king.

Piece Placing : again the players are in the later stages of development; most pieces are connected but have yet to occupy open files. White's rook at KR1 is undeveloped, as well as his bishop at KB1, but if his plan is to advance on the king side by P-KR4-5, he may develop his rook that way - by opening the rook file.

Limitation : black's bishop at KN2 is a good defensive piece, but its diagonal is blocked by the IMMOBILISED pawn at K4 (e5). The black rook at Q1 is limited by its own pawn at Q3.

The white bishop at KB1 is limited by its pawns at KN2, KB3, K4 and cannot take up a good diagonal at QB4. However, it has a good line even in its present position, leading from KB1 to QR6.

Exposure : White's advanced knight at QN5 has not a secure outpost, and is exposed to ...P-QR3. However, the knight can go to QB7, attacking two exposed black pieces, the rook at QR1 and the bishop at K3; if 1N-B7 QR-B1 2NxB comes into consideration, to obtain the two bishops.

The black queen, very far advanced, is clearly exposed. However, pieces can take liberties in the vicinity of the opposing king, because the pawns are needed there for protection, not offence.

It is true that 1P-QN3 traps the black queen, but after 1...BxNP 1PxB QxNP ch 3K-R1 (3Q-N2 QxB) P-QR3! black drives the knight away and plays ...QxRP ch, coming out with 3 pawns and some attack for the piece.

However, if black's queen is not exposed to pawns, this does not mean she is not exposed to minor pieces, and in fact the sequence 1N-B7 QR-B1 2B-QN5 traps and wins the black queen.

Pawn Structure : We have already noted how the position of kings has influenced the nature of the pawns, and that their opposite side castling has turned the white pawns at QR3, QN2 and QB2 into protectors, and the ones at KR2, KN2 into potential attackers.

The same applies, in reverse, to the black wing pawns.

The central pawns pose black a problem; his pawn at K4 (e5), as stated, blocks the bishop at KN2; the one at Q3 needs defence by pieces, and is being held back by the white pawn at K4 (e4). Given a chance the black pawn at Q3 will advance, ridding himself of a weakness, and attempting to undermine white's pawn at K4, which would help the bishop at KN2 to eventually open its diagonal. Or having moved to ...P-Q4, black could further expand with P-Q5, cramping white's position.

Having looked at all the features of the position, let us decide which are the most promising plans.

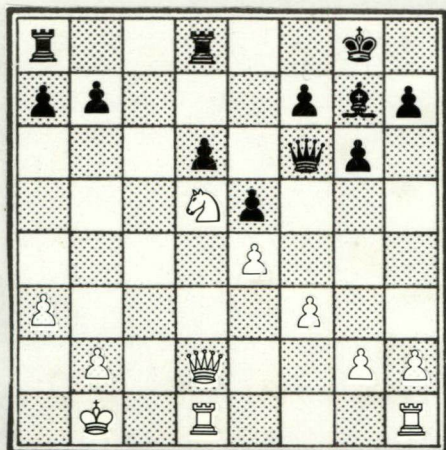
Of course, winning material by 1N-B7 and 2B-QN5 is best, but aside from that I wish to discuss the relative merits of other plans. Any move that allows black to play ...P-Q4, which he is threatening, is faulty. So a move like 1P-KR4, to start a king side attack, is misplaced. Furthermore, it is quite possible that white's king being more exposed than black's, would fall first in a pawn race starting 1PKR4 P-QR3 2NQB3 Q-R4 3P-KN4 P-QN4.

A move like 1B-KR6, standard in many positions like this is wrong because we have decided that white's chances of a king side attack are worse than black's, and white is thus exchanging off a good bishop against a bad one. A move like 1N-QB3 QR4 2P-KB4 is wrong because after 2...PxP 3BxP the diagonal of black's bishop at KN2 is opened. The sequence 1NB7 R-QB1 2NxB PxN is problematical. White has gained the two bishops and doubled black's pawns. However, he has lost a little time and black has gained the developing move ...QR-B1, and is ready to play ...P-Q4 which white cannot now stop. Also white's bishop at KB1 lacks a post (it would like to go to QN3, and must take time to develop by P-KN3 and B-KR3).

So on balance, despite the gains, white probably does not gain much by 2NxB - but the assessment is very finely balanced.

In the game (Boleslavsky - Lisitsin) white did not note the win of black's queen, but continued positionally by 1P-QB4 a seemingly crazy move, but one we can understand if we realise the importance of keeping the black pawn at Q3 IMMOBILE. Black accepted the offered pawn by 1...BxP 2N-B3 Q-N6 3BxB QxB but after 4B-N5 Q-K3 5BxN BxB 6N-Q5, we reach the diagram position

Diagram 4



Again it is strange that white should have so freely given up a pawn and then exchanged a bishop for a knight, but now he has achieved his object of playing N-Q5, reaching the sort of position where the knight is superior to the bishop.

The way to tell is:

The knight has an advanced out post with no danger of exchange (by enemy minor pieces) or exposure (to enemy pawn advances).

The pawns at Q3 and K4 have been turned into stone; they are immobile and this puts the nails in the coffin of the black bishop, whose choice of diagonal is severely limited. These factors outweigh the loss of the pawn.

I have stated in R.R.16 that most positional factors, even taken cumulatively (good knight versus bad bishop is in fact two not one positional factor) rarely outweigh a pawn. But in exceptional circumstances like this, they can be worth more.

White later won the game by opening up the king side by P-KR4, PKN4, P-R5; because of white's dominating position in the centre, black was unable to mount any reasonable attack on the queen side.

The other two positions from R.R.16 we shall investigate in the next issue.

RABBITS REVIEW is a magazine for improving players. The Editor is International Master Michael Basman. It is published six times a year. Annual subscription is £5. Specimen copy, 90p post free. Back issues Nos 1-12 are 60p. Nos 13-16 are 90p.

All prices post free from RR, 7 Billockby Close, Chessington, Surrey KT9 2ED.